



WORKERS HANDBOOK

Everything You Need to Know, In One Place

Welcome to the Team

Document Reference
ECC-WH-2026-001

Effective Date
July 1, 2026

Version
1.0

This Handbook Belongs To

British Columbia, Canada

ABOUT THIS HANDBOOK

This handbook is your go-to guide for working at Evergreen Community Care. It pulls together the things you're most likely to need — your pay, your schedule, your time off, what's expected of you, and where to turn when you have a question or a problem.

It's written in plain language on purpose. For the full legal and technical detail behind these policies, see our two companion documents:

- The Human Resources Policy Binder (ECC-HR-POL-2026-001) — the complete, formal policy reference
- The Occupational Health and Safety Program (ECC-OHS-POL-2026-001) — our full safety program
- The Residential Care Policy Manual (ECC-RC-POL-2024-001) — our standards for direct care work

If anything in this handbook ever seems to conflict with one of those documents, the formal policy binder governs. But for day-to-day questions, this handbook should answer almost everything.

Keep this somewhere handy — in your locker, your car, or saved on your phone. And if you can't find the answer here, ask. Nobody expects you to memorize a handbook; we just want you to know where to look.

Document Reference	ECC-WH-2026-001
Companion Documents	HR Policy Binder (ECC-HR-POL-2026-001); OHS Program (ECC-OHS-POL-2026-001); Residential Care Policy Manual (ECC-RC-POL-2024-001)
Effective Date	July 1, 2026
Version	1.0
Review Cycle	Annual, each July

WHAT'S INSIDE

Welcome to Evergreen Community Care
How We're Organized
Your First Days
Your Employment, Explained
Your Pay and Your Hours
Your Schedule, in More Detail
Your Benefits
Vacation and Sick Leave
Other Time Off You Might Need
How We Show Up: Conduct and Boundaries
A Respectful Workplace
Cultural Safety: What It Means in Practice
Supporting LGBTQ2S+ Youth and Coworkers
What a Shift Actually Looks Like
Working Through Real Situations
Your Training
How We Talk About Your Performance
If Something Goes Wrong
Staying Safe at Work
Taking Care of You
Your Voice and Your Concerns
If You Ever Leave
Quick Answers to Common Questions
Glossary: Terms You'll Hear Around Here
Key Contacts, at a Glance
Acknowledgement of Receipt

WELCOME TO EVERGREEN COMMUNITY CARE

Why We're Here

Evergreen Community Care supports children, youth, and families across British Columbia through residential care that's compassionate, culturally safe, and trauma-informed. Our mission is simple: supporting growth, building futures.

Every person on this team — whether you work directly with youth, behind the scenes in operations, or somewhere in between — makes that mission possible. The work isn't always easy. It's some of the most meaningful work there is, and we don't take for granted what it asks of you.

Our Values

Value	What It Looks Like Day to Day
Respect	Treating every person — youth, family, coworker — like they matter, because they do
Integrity	Doing the right thing, especially when no one's watching
Accountability	Owning your work, your mistakes, and your growth
Inclusion	Making sure everyone feels like they belong here
Collaboration	Working as a team, not in silos
Excellence	Always looking for a better way to do this work
Cultural Safety	Honouring the identities and backgrounds of everyone we serve and work with

A Note on This Work

The young people in our care have often been through more than most adults experience in a lifetime. The way we show up for them — steady, kind, and consistent — can genuinely change the direction of a life. That's a privilege and a responsibility, and it's why we hold high standards for how we work.

HOW WE'RE ORGANIZED

Who's Who

Role	What They Do
Residential Support / Care Worker	Front-line care, daily support, supervision, and programming for youth
Senior Youth Care Worker / Shift Lead	Leads a shift, mentors newer staff, handles more complex situations
Behaviour Support Specialist	Develops and supports individualized behaviour plans
Cultural Coordinator	Supports Indigenous youth's Cultural Plans and community connections
Program Supervisor / Assistant Program Manager	Day-to-day operational leadership of a facility or program
Program Manager	Overall responsibility for a program area, including staffing, budget, and MCFD relationship
Health and Safety Coordinator	Runs our Occupational Health and Safety Program organization-wide
Human Resources	Hiring, pay, benefits, leave, and employment policy questions
Director / Executive Director	Overall organizational leadership and final decision authority

Our Board of Directors

Evergreen Community Care is governed by a volunteer Board of Directors who set strategic direction, approve major policies (including this handbook), and hold the Executive Director accountable. You won't interact with the Board day-to-day, but it's good to know they're there, and ultimately accountable for the standards we hold.

Working With MCFD

The Ministry of Children and Family Development places youth with us and licenses our facilities. Each youth has an assigned MCFD social worker who is part of their care team. You'll interact with social workers regularly — through care plan meetings, updates, and day-to-day coordination. Treat this relationship as a genuine partnership; MCFD and Evergreen Community Care are working toward the same goal for every young person in our care.

Where You Fit

Whatever your role, you're part of how this organization delivers on its mission. Direct-care roles are the most visible, but operations, administration, and support roles make that frontline work possible. Every part of the team matters.

YOUR FIRST DAYS

Before You Start

By the time you walk in for your first shift, a few things should already be done:

- Your Criminal Record Check (with Vulnerable Sector Check) has cleared
- You've signed your offer letter and employment agreement
- You've completed your payroll and benefits enrollment paperwork
- You've given us your emergency contact information

If any of that hasn't happened yet, talk to Human Resources before your first shift — we can't have you start without it, and we'd rather sort it out early than rush on day one.

What Orientation Looks Like

When	What Happens
Day 1	Meet your team, tour the facility, learn the basics: where things are, who's who, how to clock in
Week 1	Review the Residential Care Policy Manual and key procedures for your role
Weeks 1–2	Work a minimum of three shifts alongside an experienced staff member before flying solo
First 30–90 days	Complete your required training (see page on Training, later in this handbook)
30 days	Quick, informal check-in with your supervisor — how's it going?
90 days	A more formal check-in on how you're settling into the role
180 days	End of your probationary period — a real conversation about how things are going and next steps

Your Probationary Period

Your first six months are a probationary period. This is normal and goes both ways — it's time for you to figure out if this role and this organization are a good fit, and for us to do the same. You'll have check-ins at 30, 90, and 180 days. None of these should be a surprise if you're getting regular feedback along the way, which you should be.

Your Mentor / Buddy

In your first week, you'll be paired with an experienced coworker who can answer the small questions that don't seem big enough to bring to your supervisor. Use them. Everyone was new once.

Questions Are Always Welcome

Asking questions when you're new isn't a weakness — it's exactly what we want. The people who struggle are the ones who guess instead of asking. If you're not sure, ask.

YOUR EMPLOYMENT, EXPLAINED

What Kind of Employee Are You?

Category	What It Means
Full-Time Permanent	Regularly scheduled 30+ hours/week, ongoing. Full benefits eligibility.
Part-Time Permanent	Regularly scheduled under 30 hours/week, ongoing. Pro-rated benefits where applicable.
Casual / Relief	No guaranteed hours; you're called in as needed. Statutory entitlements only.
Fixed-Term Contract	Employment for a defined period or project, as specified in your contract.

Not sure which one you are? Check your offer letter, or ask Human Resources.

Your Personnel File

We keep a confidential file on you — your application, reference checks, your criminal record check, evaluations, and training records. You can ask to see your own file any time; just give Human Resources reasonable notice. We keep these records for at least 7 years after you leave, as required by law.

Equal Opportunity, Always

We hire, promote, and pay people based on their qualifications and performance — full stop. Discrimination on the basis of race, religion, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, disability, age, or any other protected ground has no place here.

YOUR PAY AND YOUR HOURS

How and When You Get Paid

- You're paid every two weeks, by direct deposit
- Your pay statement shows your hours, rate, deductions, and how much leave you've banked
- Wage reviews happen annually alongside your performance review, depending on budget

Hours of Work

- Full-time hours are typically 37.5–40 hours/week
- Residential care shifts can include days, evenings, nights, weekends, and statutory holidays — schedules vary by program
- Record all your hours accurately through our timekeeping system. This isn't optional — it protects your pay and keeps us compliant with employment law

Overtime

Overtime is paid per the BC Employment Standards Act:

- 1.5x your regular wage after 8 hours in a day, or 40 hours in a week
- 2x your regular wage after 12 hours in a day
- Get your supervisor's okay before working overtime, except in a genuine emergency

Shift Premiums and On-Call

- Evening, night, and weekend shifts come with premium pay, per the current wage grid — ask your supervisor for the current rates
- If you're on-call, you're paid an on-call premium, and overtime rates apply to any hours you actually work while on call

Statutory Holidays

We observe all BC statutory holidays: New Year's Day, Family Day, Good Friday, Victoria Day, Canada Day, BC Day, Labour Day, the National Day for Truth and Reconciliation, Thanksgiving, Remembrance Day, and Christmas Day.

- If you're eligible and don't work the holiday, you get statutory holiday pay
- If you're required to work because of our residential care schedule, you get premium pay (1.5x) plus a substitute day off, or another arrangement per the current wage grid
- September 30th (National Day for Truth and Reconciliation) is formally observed, with programming supporting both staff and youth

Your Job Level and Pay Grade

Level	Example Roles
1 — Entry	Residential Support Worker (probationary)
2 — Direct Care	Residential Care Worker, Youth Care Worker
3 — Senior Direct Care	Senior Youth Care Worker, Shift Lead
4 — Specialized	Behaviour Support Specialist, Cultural Coordinator

5 — Supervisory	Program Supervisor, Assistant Program Manager
6 — Management	Program Manager, Director

YOUR SCHEDULE, IN MORE DETAIL

How Shifts Are Built

Residential care runs around the clock, which means our schedules look different from a typical 9-to-5 workplace. Shifts are built to meet minimum staffing ratios required by our MCFD license and to give youth the consistency they need.

Getting Your Schedule

- Schedules are typically posted at least 2 weeks in advance
- You'll receive your schedule through our scheduling system or from your supervisor, depending on your facility
- If a schedule conflict comes up, raise it with your supervisor as early as possible — the earlier we know, the easier it is to solve

Shift Swaps

1. Find a qualified coworker willing to trade shifts with you
2. Confirm the swap doesn't create a staffing ratio, training, or certification gap (for example, if a shift needs someone with medication administration training)
3. Get your supervisor's approval before the swap is final — don't assume it's fine until you hear back
4. Both people remain responsible for making sure the shift is actually covered

Calling in Sick

- Call your supervisor as early as possible — ideally at least 2 hours before your shift starts
- Late notice makes it harder to find coverage, which affects the youth in our care, so please give as much notice as you can
- If you're sick a lot in a short period, your supervisor may check in with you — this is about your wellbeing, not punishment

Being Late

If you're running late, call your supervisor right away so the outgoing shift isn't left waiting and coverage can be arranged if needed. We'd much rather get a heads-up call than have someone just not show up.

On-Call Shifts

Some roles include on-call availability for emergency coverage. If you're on-call, you'll be paid an on-call premium, and overtime rates apply for any hours you actually end up working.

Statutory Holiday Coverage

Because residential care doesn't stop for holidays, some staff will be scheduled to work statutory holidays. If that's you, you'll get premium pay plus a substitute day off, or another arrangement per the current wage grid — see "Your Pay and Your Hours" for details.

YOUR BENEFITS

What You're Eligible For

Benefit	Full-Time	Part-Time	Casual
Extended health & dental	After 3 months	After 6 months (avg. 15+ hrs/wk)	Not eligible
Group life / AD&D insurance	After 3 months	After 6 months	Not eligible
Employee & Family Assistance Program	Day 1	Day 1	Day 1
Pension / Group RRSP matching	After 1 year	After 1 year (pro-rated)	Not eligible

Extended Health and Dental

Coverage includes prescription drugs, paramedical services like massage and physiotherapy, counselling, vision, and dental care. You'll get the full plan booklet when you enroll. You can add eligible dependents during enrollment or within 30 days of a life event like a marriage or new baby.

Your Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP)

This one's worth knowing about from day one. You and your immediate family get free, confidential access to counselling, legal advice, financial counselling, and crisis support — 24/7, by phone, and often virtually or in person too.

Nobody at Evergreen Community Care finds out if you use it or why. It's completely confidential. EFAP contact info is posted in every staff area.

VACATION AND SICK LEAVE

Vacation

Years of Service	Annual Vacation
Under 5 years	3 weeks (15 days)
5–9 years	4 weeks (20 days)
10+ years	5 weeks (25 days)

- This is more generous than the BC legal minimum at every service level
- Request your vacation at least 4 weeks ahead — approval depends on staffing needs at the time
- You can carry over up to 5 unused days to the next year with your supervisor's okay; anything beyond that is paid out per legislation

Paid Sick Leave

- If you're full-time permanent, you accrue paid sick leave consistent with the BC Employment Standards Act — currently 5 paid sick days a year after 90 days of employment
- Longer-term illness or injury may qualify for additional unpaid, job-protected leave under the Employment Standards Act
- We may ask for a doctor's note if you're away more than 3 days in a row
- Unused sick days don't carry over or get paid out — they reset each year

OTHER TIME OFF YOU MIGHT NEED

Life happens. BC law protects your job during several kinds of leave, and we want you to actually use these when you need them.

If You Need...	You Can Take...	Paid or Unpaid?
Time off for a new baby (pregnancy)	Up to 17 weeks	Unpaid (EI maternity benefits may apply)
Time off as a new parent	Up to 61–62 weeks	Unpaid (EI parental benefits may apply)
To care for a family member	Up to 5 days/year	Unpaid
Bereavement (loss of a family member)	Up to 3 days	Paid for immediate family; unpaid beyond
To care for someone with a serious illness	Up to 27 weeks	Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)
A child's critical illness or injury	Up to 36 weeks	Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)
An adult family member's critical illness/injury	Up to 16 weeks	Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)
Support after domestic or sexual violence	Up to 10 days + 15 weeks	First 5 days paid; rest unpaid
Jury duty	Duration of service	Unpaid

Pregnancy and Parental Leave, in Plain Terms

- Give us at least 4 weeks' written notice before you start your leave
- Apply for EI maternity/parental benefits — we don't top these up unless your individual agreement says otherwise
- Keep paying your share of benefit premiums and your coverage continues while you're away
- When you're ready to come back, you're reinstated to your old job or something comparable, at the same pay

Cultural and Ceremonial Leave

If you're an Indigenous employee and need time for significant cultural or ceremonial practices — potlatches, ceremonies, community events — talk to your supervisor. We'll accommodate this wherever we can, using unpaid leave or your vacation time, with reasonable notice.

Religious Observance

We'll work with you to accommodate religious observances — give us as much notice as you can, and we'll figure out the schedule together.

Personal Leave

Need time off for something not covered above? You can request an unpaid personal leave of absence in writing. We'll look at it case by case, based on what's going on operationally.

HOW WE SHOW UP: CONDUCT AND BOUNDARIES

The Basics

You're expected to act with honesty, integrity, and professionalism — on shift and off. That's true everywhere, but it matters extra here because of who we serve.

Professional Boundaries

This is one of the most important sections in this whole handbook. Clear boundaries protect both you and the young people in our care.

- Keep relationships with youth and families professional — always
- Don't develop personal, romantic, or financial relationships with current or former clients
- Don't give or accept significant gifts to or from a child, youth, or family in care
- Don't connect with youth or families on personal social media — use approved organizational channels only
- Don't be alone with a single youth outside the facility's normal supervision routines, except where safety requires it
- If you're ever unsure whether something crosses a boundary line, talk to your supervisor right away. Asking is always the right move.

Confidentiality

You'll have access to sensitive information about children, youth, and families. Protecting that information is part of the job, not an afterthought.

- Don't discuss client information outside of work — not with friends, not on social media, not "just this once"
- Only access client information when you actually need it to do your job
- Report any privacy slip-up — yours or someone else's — to your supervisor or our Privacy Officer right away
- This obligation doesn't end when you leave Evergreen Community Care. It's permanent

You'll sign a Confidentiality Agreement as part of your onboarding. Take it seriously — breaching confidentiality can mean discipline up to termination, and can have legal consequences too.

Conflicts of Interest

If something could look like a conflict of interest — a personal relationship with a client's family, a financial stake in a vendor we use, a second job that overlaps with your duties — tell your supervisor. We'd rather know and work through it together than find out later.

Technology and Social Media

- Work email, phones, and computers are for work — light personal use is fine, just don't let it get in the way
- Never post photos, names, or identifying details about youth in care on personal social media. Ever.
- Don't post anything publicly that disparages the organization, your coworkers, or our clients
- Think of yourself as representing Evergreen Community Care any time you're posting publicly — because you are

Substance Use

- Don't come to work, or be on shift, under the influence of alcohol, cannabis, or non-prescribed drugs
- Don't drink or use cannabis on our property, except at staff-only organization-sanctioned events — and never around the kids
- If you're taking medication that might affect your judgment or reaction time, let your supervisor know

This is a zero-tolerance area for direct-care roles, given who we look after. Confirmed impairment on shift can mean immediate removal from duty and possible termination.

Dress and Presentation

Dress professionally, practically, and appropriately for working with kids and youth. Your Program Manager can give you site-specific guidance.

A RESPECTFUL WORKPLACE

Our Commitment

You deserve to work somewhere free of harassment, discrimination, bullying, and violence. That's true in how we treat each other, and how clients, families, and the public treat you.

What This Covers

Term	What It Means
Harassment	Unwelcome conduct or comments that demean, humiliate, or embarrass someone
Discrimination	Being treated unfairly because of a protected characteristic (race, gender, disability, etc.)
Sexual Harassment	Unwelcome sexual conduct that affects your work environment or job
Bullying	Repeated, unwanted behaviour meant to demean or intimidate
Workplace Violence	Any threat or act of physical force that causes or could cause injury

If This Happens to You — or You See It Happen

5. Tell your supervisor, Human Resources, or — if it involves your supervisor — go to the next level of management or the Executive Director
6. You can report verbally or in writing; either way, we'll document it
7. We take this seriously and investigate promptly and as confidentially as we reasonably can
8. Most investigations wrap up within 10 business days; complicated ones may take longer, and we'll keep you posted
9. We may put interim measures in place — like a schedule change — to keep everyone safe while we investigate

You Won't Be Punished for Speaking Up

Retaliation against anyone who reports harassment in good faith, or who supports someone else's complaint, is itself a serious violation. We mean that.

Outside Options

You always have the right to take a complaint to the BC Human Rights Tribunal or WorkSafeBC directly, whether or not you've gone through our internal process first.

CULTURAL SAFETY: WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE

Why This Matters Here

Indigenous children and youth are significantly overrepresented in BC's child welfare system — a direct legacy of residential schools and colonization. Working here means actively participating in reconciliation, not just avoiding harm.

What You'll Be Expected to Do

- Complete Indigenous Cultural Safety and Humility training within 60 days, and refresh it annually
- Support each Indigenous youth's Cultural Plan — their connection to community, language, ceremony, and identity isn't optional extra programming, it's core to their care
- Help facilitate cultural practices in the home: smudging, ceremony, traditional foods, regalia care, and connection with Elders or cultural mentors
- Use the language and pronunciation a youth or family uses for their Nation, community, and traditional territory — ask if you're unsure, and don't guess
- Recognize that a youth's connection to their Nation, band, or community is something we actively support, not something we passively allow

Working With Indigenous Families and Nations

You may work alongside band social workers, Friendship Centre staff, Elders, and cultural coordinators as part of a youth's care team. Treat their input as expert knowledge — because it is.

If You Make a Mistake

Cultural humility means recognizing you won't always get it right, and that's okay — what matters is how you respond. If you mispronounce something, use the wrong term, or miss a cultural nuance, the right move is a simple, genuine correction and a continued effort to learn, not defensiveness.

Truth and Reconciliation

We formally observe the National Day for Truth and Reconciliation (September 30) and are guided by the Truth and Reconciliation Commission's Calls to Action relevant to child welfare. This isn't a once-a-year gesture — it shapes how we hire, train, and deliver care year-round.

SUPPORTING LGBTQ2S+ YOUTH AND COWORKERS

Our Commitment

Every young person and every coworker deserves to be respected for who they are — including their sexual orientation, gender identity, and gender expression. This isn't a side policy; it's part of how we practice trauma-informed, dignity-centred care.

With Youth in Our Care

- Use a youth's stated name and pronouns, every time — regardless of what's on their legal documents
- Never share a youth's sexual orientation or gender identity with family, MCFD, or anyone else without their consent, unless there's a genuine safety reason
- Support access to gender-affirming clothing, personal care items, and mental health resources as part of their normal care
- Bedroom and washroom arrangements should reflect a youth's gender identity wherever we can make that work
- If a youth experiences harassment from peers or anyone else because of who they are, that gets addressed immediately — zero tolerance

With Each Other

- Use inclusive language and don't make assumptions about anyone's gender, relationships, or family structure
- Discrimination against a coworker because of their sexual orientation or gender identity is treated exactly as seriously as any other form of discrimination — see "A Respectful Workplace"

Training

You'll complete LGBTQ2S+ Inclusion and Cultural Humility training within 60 days of starting, refreshed annually. If you ever have questions about how to support a specific youth's needs in this area, ask your supervisor — better to ask than to guess.

WHAT A SHIFT ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

If you're new to direct care, it can help to know roughly what to expect. Every facility and shift is a little different, but here's a general shape of things.

Typical Day Shift

Time	What's Happening
Start of shift	Shift handover — outgoing staff brief you on anything important: how the youth are doing, any incidents, appointments coming up
Morning	Support with breakfast, getting ready for school or programming, medication administration if applicable
Midday	Documentation, appointments, check-ins, household tasks, 1:1 time with youth
Afternoon	School pickup/support, recreational or life skills programming, meal prep
Evening	Dinner, family contact calls if scheduled, downtime, bedtime routines
End of shift	Shift handover to the next staff — what they need to know going into their shift

Documentation You'll Do

- Daily shift logs — what happened, how the youth are doing
- Medication Administration Records, if that applies to your role
- Incident reports, if anything significant happens
- Notes toward a youth's Care Plan or Behaviour Support Plan goals

Good documentation matters more than it might seem in the moment — it's how the next shift, the care team, and MCFD understand what's going on with each youth. Write factually, stick to what you observed, and don't editorialize.

When Things Get Hard

Some shifts are genuinely difficult — a youth in crisis, a hard conversation, a sleepless night. That's part of this work. Use your de-escalation training, call for backup when you need it, and lean on your team. Nobody expects you to handle everything solo, and asking for backup is a sign of good judgment, not weakness.

WORKING THROUGH REAL SITUATIONS

Policies are easier to apply when you've thought through how they actually play out. Here are some common situations and how to think about them.

"A youth wants to add me on social media."

Politely decline and explain that staff can't connect with youth on personal social media — it's not personal, it's a boundary that protects everyone. Mention it to your supervisor so it's documented and the youth's care team is aware.

"A youth tells me something that sounds like it could be abuse, but asks me to keep it secret."

You cannot promise confidentiality here. Gently let the youth know that some things you have to share with the right people to keep them safe, then report it immediately to your supervisor and the MCFD child protection line. This overrides every other policy in this handbook — reporting suspected abuse is a legal duty, not optional.

"I made a documentation error in a shift log."

Don't erase or White-Out it. Draw a single line through the error, initial it, and write the correction beside it, dated. Tell your supervisor if the error was significant. Honest mistakes handled transparently are not a big deal; covering them up is.

"A coworker is talking about a youth's situation at a coffee shop, where others could overhear."

Confidentiality applies everywhere, not just on shift. It's reasonable to gently flag this to your coworker in the moment if you're comfortable, and to mention it to your supervisor regardless — this is a privacy issue worth addressing.

"I think a task I've been asked to do is unsafe."

Say so, right away, to your supervisor. You have a real legal right to refuse unsafe work (see "Staying Safe at Work"). You won't be punished for raising it in good faith, even if it turns out the task was actually fine.

"A youth is escalating and I'm not sure I can de-escalate them alone."

Call for backup early — before things peak, not after. Use your NVCI training, prioritize safety over control, and remember that needing help is normal in this work, not a failure.

"I'm scheduled with a coworker I'm having a conflict with."

Try to resolve the conflict directly and professionally first. If that's not working, or it's affecting the workplace or care quality, bring it to your supervisor — that's exactly the kind of thing we want to know about before it festers.

"A parent or family member asks me directly for information about a youth's case."

Politely redirect them to the youth's MCFD social worker. You're not in a position to share case information, even with good intentions — that's the social worker's role, working within the youth's care plan and consent.

"I'm not sure if something counts as a 'near-miss' worth reporting."

Report it anyway. Near-misses are how we catch hazards before someone actually gets hurt — there's no such thing as too small to mention when it comes to safety.

"I disagree with how my supervisor handled a situation with a youth."

Raise it privately and respectfully with your supervisor first — not in front of the youth or other staff. If you're not comfortable doing that, or it doesn't resolve, use the process in "Your Voice and Your Concerns."

YOUR TRAINING

What You Need to Complete, and By When

Training	Complete By
First Aid / CPR (Level C)	Before your first unsupervised shift
WHMIS (workplace hazardous materials)	Before your first shift
Non-Violent Crisis Intervention (NVCI)	Within 90 days
Trauma-Informed Practice	Within 60 days
Indigenous Cultural Safety and Humility	Within 60 days
LGBTQ2S+ Inclusion and Cultural Humility	Within 60 days
Privacy and FOIPPA	Within 30 days
Duty to Report (child protection law)	Within 30 days
Medication Administration (if your role needs it)	Within 60 days
Abuse Prevention and Recognition	Within 60 days

Most of these need refreshing annually. We track this for you, but it's your responsibility to actually attend and complete them. If your training lapses, you may be pulled from independent shifts until you're caught up — this isn't a punishment, it's about everyone's safety, including yours.

Growing With Us

- You and your supervisor will build a professional development plan together each year
- We put a minimum of \$500/year per full-time employee toward your development — courses, conferences, certifications — budget permitting
- We especially want to support growth in trauma-informed care, cultural safety, clinical certifications, and leadership
- Want to pursue further education? You may be able to take unpaid education leave of up to 12 months — talk to HR at least 60 days ahead

HOW WE TALK ABOUT YOUR PERFORMANCE

It's a Conversation, Not Just a Form

Performance reviews here aren't meant to be a once-a-year ambush. We want ongoing, two-way conversations about how things are going — what's working, what's hard, and where you want to grow.

Your Annual Review

- Happens once a year, usually around your hire date anniversary
- Covers care quality, cultural safety, teamwork, training compliance, documentation, and professional conduct
- You'll do a self-assessment too — this is a two-way conversation
- You and your supervisor both sign off, and it goes in your file

How We Rate Things

Rating	What It Means
Exceeds Expectations	You're consistently going above and beyond
Meets Expectations	You're consistently doing what the role requires — this is a good place to be
Developing	You're meeting most expectations, with specific areas we're working on together
Needs Improvement	There are gaps that need a formal improvement plan

If Things Aren't on Track

If your performance dips below expectations, you'll get a Performance Improvement Plan — a clear, written outline of the concern, what's expected, what support you'll get, and a realistic timeline (usually 30–60 days). The goal is always to help you succeed, not to set you up to fail.

Getting Recognized

- Employee of the Quarter recognizes standout performance
- Peer-nominated awards are presented at quarterly all-staff meetings
- We mark service milestones at 1, 3, 5, 10, and 15+ years

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Our Approach

Most performance or conduct issues get handled through progressive discipline — a fair, step-by-step process that gives you a real chance to course-correct before things escalate.

Step	What Happens
1	A verbal warning — an informal conversation about the issue and what needs to change
2	A written warning — documented, with clear expectations going forward
3	A final written warning or formal Performance Improvement Plan
4	Suspension or termination, if things still haven't improved

You'll always know what the concern is before any disciplinary meeting, and you'll get a chance to share your side before any final decision is made. You can ask for support-person representation where applicable.

When We Skip the Steps

Some things are serious enough to bypass this process entirely — meaning immediate suspension or termination. This includes:

- Any act, or suspected act, of abuse, neglect, or exploitation of a child or youth
- Using a prohibited restraint or seclusion
- Being impaired on shift
- Theft, fraud, or financial misconduct
- Workplace violence or serious threats
- Falsifying records, including incident reports
- Breaching confidentiality involving sensitive child protection information
- Failing to report suspected child abuse, which is a legal obligation under the Child, Family and Community Service Act

Got a Concern About How You've Been Treated?

If you disagree with a decision or feel something wasn't handled fairly, you can raise it. Start with your supervisor. If that doesn't resolve it, you can put your concern in writing and work your way up through Human Resources, your Program Manager, and ultimately the Executive Director. See "Your Voice and Your Concerns" later in this handbook for the full process.

STAYING SAFE AT WORK

Safety Is Everyone's Job

We're committed to a safe workplace — that's not just a slogan, it's a legal obligation under the BC Workers Compensation Act. But policy alone doesn't keep anyone safe. You play a role too.

What You're Responsible For

- Follow safe work procedures and use any required protective equipment
- Report hazards, near-misses, and unsafe conditions right away — don't wait
- Show up for required safety training
- Refuse unsafe work and tell your supervisor immediately if you do (see below — this is a real legal right)

If You Get Hurt, Even a Little

10. Tell your supervisor immediately — even for something minor
11. Get first aid or medical attention right away if you need it
12. An Incident Report gets filled out within 24 hours
13. If it's serious, we report it to WorkSafeBC and may need to preserve the scene — don't clean up or move anything until told it's okay

Report every injury, even ones that seem too small to mention. A pattern of "small" incidents often points to a bigger hazard we need to fix.

Your Right to Refuse Unsafe Work

This is a real legal right under BC law, not just a nice idea. If you genuinely believe a task is unsafe to you or anyone else, you can refuse to do it.

14. Tell your supervisor right away and explain why
15. Your supervisor investigates with you — and a JHSC rep, if you want one there
16. If the hazard is real, it gets fixed before the work continues, or you're given other reasonable work
17. If you and your supervisor don't agree on whether it's unsafe, it goes to our Joint Health and Safety Committee, or to WorkSafeBC if needed

Nobody will punish you for refusing unsafe work in good faith. Full stop.

Workplace Violence Prevention

Given the nature of this work, we take workplace violence prevention seriously — including violence that may come from a trauma response in a client we serve.

- You'll complete Non-Violent Crisis Intervention (NVCI) training within 90 days of starting
- If you work alone, you'll have a check-in protocol — know what yours is
- Personal safety devices (phone, radio, alarm) are provided where the risk assessment calls for it
- If you're ever facing an imminent threat: create distance, de-escalate if you can, call for backup, use your safety device, and call 911 if there's real risk of serious injury
- After any violent incident, you'll get a debrief within 48 hours and access to extra support if you need it — and you won't be pushed back into high-demand duties before you're ready

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- We provide PPE at no cost to you for any task that needs it — gloves, masks, eye protection, whatever applies
- You'll be trained on how to use it properly
- Damaged or worn-out PPE gets replaced — just ask

Joint Health and Safety Committee (JHSC)

We have a Joint Health and Safety Committee made up of both management and worker representatives. They review hazards, investigate incidents, do monthly inspections, and meet monthly. Their meeting minutes are posted — check them out, and bring your concerns to a worker rep any time.

Want the Full Detail?

This section hits the highlights. For our complete Occupational Health and Safety Program — including our full Workplace Violence Prevention Program, emergency response plans, and return-to-work program — see ECC-OHS-POL-2026-001.

TAKING CARE OF YOU

This Work Is Hard. We Know.

Caring for kids and youth who've experienced trauma is some of the most meaningful work there is — and it can also wear you down. Vicarious trauma and compassion fatigue are real, and we'd rather talk about them openly than pretend they don't happen.

Your Employee and Family Assistance Program

Worth repeating: you and your family have free, confidential access to counselling, legal advice, financial help, and crisis support, 24/7. Nobody at Evergreen Community Care knows if or why you use it.

Reflective Supervision and Peer Support

- You'll get monthly reflective supervision sessions — separate from your performance review, just space to process the work
- Peer support programs connect you with trained coworkers for informal debriefing
- Team debriefs happen after particularly tough shifts or incidents

After a Critical Incident

If something significant happens — a serious injury, a violent incident, a death — everyone involved gets a structured debrief within 48 hours, facilitated by your Program Manager or an outside clinician. You won't be sent straight back into high-demand duties without support. Extra counselling is available at no cost to you if you need it.

Protecting Your Time

- We try to schedule adequate rest between your shifts
- Use your full vacation entitlement — we mean it, not just as a courtesy
- Mandatory overtime is avoided wherever we can manage it

If You're Struggling

If you're finding the work overwhelming, please talk to someone — your supervisor, HR, or the EFAP. Asking for help here isn't a weakness; for this kind of work, it's a sign of good judgment.

YOUR VOICE AND YOUR CONCERNS

Most Things Get Solved With a Conversation

If something's bothering you about your job — a scheduling issue, how a policy is being applied, a disagreement with a decision — start by talking to your supervisor. Most things get sorted out right there.

If That Doesn't Work

18. Put your concern in writing to your supervisor, with the relevant facts and what resolution you're looking for — within 20 business days of the issue
19. Your supervisor responds in writing within 10 business days
20. Still not resolved? Take it to the Program Manager in writing within 10 business days
21. The Program Manager investigates and responds within 10 business days
22. Still unresolved? You can take it to the Executive Director for a final internal review

If You're in a Union

If you're covered by a collective agreement, that agreement's grievance process applies instead, except where this handbook doesn't conflict with it.

You Always Have Outside Options

Whatever happens internally, you can take a concern to the BC Employment Standards Branch, the BC Human Rights Tribunal, or WorkSafeBC at any time. You don't have to exhaust our internal process first.

Have an Idea, Not Just a Complaint?

We genuinely want to hear it. Bring suggestions for improving programs, processes, or the workplace to your supervisor, a team meeting, or directly to Human Resources.

IF YOU EVER LEAVE

Resigning

- Please give us at least two weeks' written notice (four weeks if you're in a supervisory or management role)
- Submit your resignation in writing to your supervisor and Human Resources
- We'll offer you an exit interview — your honest feedback helps us improve

If We Have to Let You Go

If your employment ends without cause, you'll receive written notice or pay in place of notice, based on BC Employment Standards Act minimums or your employment contract, whichever gives you more:

Length of Service	Minimum Notice / Pay
3 months – 1 year	1 week
1 – 3 years	2 weeks
3 – 4 years	3 weeks
4 – 5 years	4 weeks
5 – 6 years	5 weeks
6 – 7 years	6 weeks
7 – 8 years	7 weeks
8+ years	8 weeks

Your individual contract or other circumstances could mean you're entitled to more than these minimums.

What Happens on Your Way Out

- You'll get your final pay — including any owed vacation pay — within the legally required timeframe (48 hours if we end your employment, 6 days if you resign)
- We'll issue your Record of Employment (ROE) within 5 days
- Return your keys, access cards, devices, uniform, and any client-related materials
- Your system access gets turned off on your last working day
- We'll let you know your options for continuing or converting your benefits

References

We're happy to confirm dates of employment and position held for any future employer. Detailed performance references are only given with your written consent.

QUICK ANSWERS TO COMMON QUESTIONS

I'm sick and can't come in. What do I do?

Call your supervisor as early as possible, ideally at least 2 hours before your shift, so we can arrange coverage. Use your paid sick leave if you're eligible.

How do I request vacation?

Submit your request at least 4 weeks ahead through our scheduling system or to your supervisor directly. Approval depends on staffing needs at the time.

Who do I tell if I see something unsafe?

Your supervisor, right away. You can also bring it to a JHSC worker representative or report it anonymously if you prefer.

What if I think a child is being abused or neglected?

Report it immediately — to your supervisor and to the MCFD child protection line. This is a legal duty under the Child, Family and Community Service Act, and it overrides any other internal process. When in doubt, report.

Can I use my phone on shift?

Personal phone use should be minimal and never interfere with supervision of youth. Check your facility's specific guidance with your supervisor.

What if I'm not sure whether something is a boundary violation?

Ask your supervisor. Every time. There's no such thing as a silly question when it comes to professional boundaries.

How do I access the Employee and Family Assistance Program?

Contact information is posted in every staff area. It's confidential — we don't find out if or why you use it.

My training is overdue. What happens?

You may be restricted from independent shifts until you're caught up. Talk to your supervisor or HR right away to get it scheduled — this isn't punitive, it's about safety.

I disagree with my performance review. What can I do?

Talk to your supervisor first. If you're still not satisfied, you can use the process in "Your Voice and Your Concerns" to escalate.

Can I switch shifts with a coworker?

Usually yes, with supervisor approval and as long as it doesn't create a training, certification, or staffing-ratio gap. Check with your supervisor.

GLOSSARY: TERMS YOU'LL HEAR AROUND HERE

New to this sector? Here are some terms and acronyms that come up often.

MCFD	Ministry of Children and Family Development — the BC government ministry that places youth in our care and licenses our facilities
CFCSA	Child, Family and Community Service Act — the core BC law governing child protection and the rights of children in care
CCALA	Community Care and Assisted Living Act — the BC law under which our facilities are licensed
Care Plan	The individualized plan for each youth covering their health, education, cultural needs, family contact, and goals
Behaviour Support Plan (BSP)	An individualized, trauma-informed plan for supporting a youth with specific behavioural needs
Cultural Plan	A plan developed for Indigenous youth to support and strengthen their cultural identity and community connection
NVCI	Non-Violent Crisis Intervention — our required training for safely de-escalating crisis situations
JHSC	Joint Health and Safety Committee — the worker/management committee that oversees workplace safety
WorkSafeBC	BC's workers' compensation board, which sets and enforces workplace safety standards
WHMIS	Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System — training on safely handling hazardous products
EFAP	Employee and Family Assistance Program — free, confidential counselling and support for you and your family
Trauma-informed care	An approach to care that recognizes the impact of past trauma and prioritizes safety, trust, and choice
ACEs	Adverse Childhood Experiences — potentially traumatic events before age 18 that shape development and behaviour
Restrictive practice	Any intervention (like restraint) that limits a youth's freedom — heavily regulated and mostly prohibited here
Critical incident	A serious event (injury, abuse allegation, runaway, etc.) requiring immediate reporting to MCFD
Two-Spirit	A term used by some Indigenous people to describe gender, sexual, and spiritual identity, rooted in specific Indigenous traditions

KEY CONTACTS, AT A GLANCE

Who	What For	How to Reach
Your Supervisor	Day-to-day questions, scheduling, concerns	Site-specific — see your orientation package
Human Resources	Pay, benefits, leave, policy questions	See staff intranet / HR office
Health and Safety Coordinator	Safety hazards, incidents, OHS questions	See OHS bulletin board at your facility
On-Call Supervisor (24/7)	After-hours emergencies, urgent decisions	Posted at every facility
Employee and Family Assistance Program	Confidential counselling, crisis support	Posted in every staff area, 24/7
MCFD Child Protection Line (24/7)	Suspected abuse or neglect of a child in care	1-800-663-9122
Executive Director	Final escalation point for unresolved concerns	Via Human Resources
JHSC Worker Representative	Safety concerns, hazard reports	Posted on OHS bulletin board

This handbook works alongside our full policy library. If you want the complete detail behind anything in here, ask Human Resources for:

- HR Policy Binder — ECC-HR-POL-2026-001
- Occupational Health and Safety Program — ECC-OHS-POL-2026-001
- Residential Care Policy Manual — ECC-RC-POL-2024-001

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIPT

Please sign and return this page to Human Resources — we'll keep it in your personnel file.

Employee Name	
Position Title	
Facility / Program	
Date	

I confirm that I have received the Evergreen Community Care Workers Handbook (ECC-WH-2026-001). I understand that it summarizes key policies and points me to our full policy documents for complete detail. I understand it's my responsibility to read it, ask questions if anything is unclear, and follow the policies and procedures it describes.

I understand that failure to follow these policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employee — Signature / Date

Supervisor / HR Representative — Signature / Date

Thank you for being part of Evergreen Community Care. The work you do matters more than you might realize on any given day.